

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2

PAPER 2 June 2023

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to June 2023 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

The mill after dark

The grinding mill at Chikwarakwara ran after dark because electricity, when it came, came like a guest who had lost the address. People sat on maize sacks under a naked bulb that flickered as if it were thinking. Pairo, who was twelve, had been sent with a bucket of grain and instructions not to talk to strangers, which was difficult when the whole ward was in the queue.

A woman sang hymns under her breath. A man complained that the miller overcharged when it rained, as if weather were a spice he added to the price. Pairo watched the miller's hands. They were white with mealie-meal, gentle with the machine and short with people. When Pairo's turn came, the belt slipped. The miller swore, not at the boy, at the belt, and for ten minutes the bulb and the night were equally useless.

In that uselessness, a girl from Pairo's school, two classes above, shared roasted maputi from a pocket. She did not ask why he was out so late. She talked about a teacher who made history sound like gossip, which was, she said, the only way some of it could be swallowed. Pairo laughed and then remembered the instruction about strangers, and then decided that a girl with maputi was not what his mother had meant.

The belt was fixed. Grain became meal with a roar that ended conversation. Walking home, the bucket heavier, Pairo felt the path with his feet because the moon was stingy. He thought of the miller, married to a machine, and of the girl who had made the wait smaller. He would not tell the whole story at home. He would say the mill was crowded and the price was the same. Some truths, he was beginning to understand, were for keeping in the mouth like a sweet, not for putting on the table.

2. (a) Why does the mill operate after dark? [2] (b) What impression do you get of the miller? [4] (c) How does the girl change Pairo's wait? [3] (d) Why does Pairo decide she is not the 'stranger' his mother meant? [3] (e) Explain the last sentence in your own words. [4] (f) What does "the moon was stingy" mean? [4] **[20]**
3. In not more than 160 words, summarise Pairo's evening at the mill and what he chooses to tell at home. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. You bump into a teacher who is carrying a pile of books. The most appropriate thing to say is: **[2]**

- A) Watch where you're going!
- B) Those books are too many anyway.
- C) Move, I was here first.
- D) Sorry, Sir/Madam. Let me help you with those.

5. Your little brother spills tea on a visitor. You say to the visitor: **[2]**

- A) I'm so sorry. Let me fetch a cloth.
- B) It's only tea.
- C) You should have moved.
- D) He's always clumsy.

6. You answer a landline in an office. The proper opening is: **[2]**

- A) Yes?
- B) Who is this?
- C) Talk, I'm listening.
- D) Good morning, Mutasa High School, may I help you?

7. At a funeral, a neighbour is grieving. You should say: **[2]**

- A) At least they were old.
- B) You'll get over it.
- C) I'm sorry for your loss. I am here with you.
- D) Let's discuss the will.

8. You are late for a lesson. When you enter, you should say: **[2]**

- A) The other class is also late.
- B) It's not my fault, the bell is wrong.
- C) May I come in, Sir/Madam? I am sorry I am late.
- D) What did I miss?

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).